

Title	LDaCA Collecting Strategy			
Description	Outline for a decision-making framework for selecting, preparing and including language data collections in the LDaCA Data Portals			
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1.0	CP	First draft complete	23/07/2025	Draft
1.1	RM	Updates to draft content	11/08/2025	Draft
1.2	CP	Responding to changes from Steering committee: • Updated wording to incorporate feedback as needed • Inclusion of Out of scope component to clarify exclusions	17/10/2025	Published

Introduction

Strategic Vision/Statement

Through the Language Data Commons of Australia (LDaCA), nationally significant language data is accessible for research, education and community use both within and beyond universities.

Purpose

LDaCA's Collection Strategy provides a framework for decision-making on what language data collections will be collected, prepared and included in LDaCA outcomes. It constitutes nationally significant language data. The Strategy demarcates what LDaCA works with and why, with a criteria for content-specific decision-making.

The term "Nationally Significant Language Data" refers to collections of language data that hold cultural, historical or practical importance at a national level for linguistic and humanities work. LDaCA's mission is to ensure that these valuable resources are preserved, accessible and usable for research, education and community purposes. This includes adhering to the FAIR (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable, Reusable) and CARE (Collective Benefit, Authority to Control, Responsibility, Ethics) principles to manage and share data in a culturally and ethically appropriate manner.

Guiding principles

- Users are able to find language collection data relevant for their work.
- Language data collections are made appropriately accessible.
- Collections represent the linguistic diversity of Australia.
- Indigenous languages, knowledge and cultural resilience are prioritised and honoured.
- Collections are cared for and maintained according to FAIR and CARE principles.
- A PILARS approach to archival repository systems is successfully applied.

Collections Criteria

How we decide

LDaCA applies three selection criteria when evaluating collections for inclusion in LDaCA work — **content**, **impact** and **feasibility**. Each criterion encompasses a range of factors.

Content

- *Research value* — Materials are selected based on their potential to significantly contribute to linguistic and cultural research.
- *Representation* — The collection aims to reflect the diversity of Australian languages, communities and contexts. It also aims to represent a wide range of communication methods including spoken, written, signed and visual languages.
- *Uniqueness* — Priority is given to collections that are not readily accessible through other platforms or repositories.
- *Quality* — Materials are selected based on the high standard of methods used to obtain them, their accuracy, and the completeness of metadata, provenance and licensing (with support from LDaCA to collate if needed).
- *Analytics opportunities* — Analytics processes are able to be applied to the collection, and the collection presents a good opportunity to demonstrate the impact of analytics tools or methods.
- *Relevance* — Selected materials should include at least one of the following:
 - Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander languages
 - Australian Englishes
 - Regional languages of the Pacific
 - Australian, Regional and Pacific gesture or sign languages
 - Languages other than English spoken in Australia
 - Emerging forms of language e.g. emoji

Impact

- *Ability to enable, establish or grow connection with diverse audiences and communities* — Materials are chosen for their potential to foster meaningful engagement and collaboration with a wide range of audiences and communities.
- *Level of anticipated usage* — Materials that are expected to have significant demand and utility across research, education and community contexts.
- *Ability to meet needs of target audiences* — Selected materials must address the specific needs and interests of the intended users, including researchers, educators and community members.

Feasibility

- *Storage requirements* — Whether or not LDaCA would need to supply or source storage and the capacity of the project to accommodate the storage space needed.
- *Availability* — The inclusion of materials that are readily available with minimal processing or support might be expedited.
- *Copyright status* — Collections must have clear copyright permissions or the potential to secure them for use.
- *Indigenous Cultural and Intellectual Property rights (ICIP) considerations* — Materials that include ICIP must include documentation of ICIP requirements, and inclusion and usage in the portals must respect and comply with the relevant ICIP requirements. Ethical and culturally appropriate access and usage requirements must be able to be adhered to.
- *Extent of data preparation required* — The level of effort needed to prepare the data for inclusion is evaluated, with support available for necessary preparation.
- *Maintenance requirements* — The ongoing maintenance needs of the materials are considered to ensure long-term usability and accessibility.
- *Format* — Only materials that are already in a digital format or can be digitised efficiently outside of LDaCA resourcing are considered. Other format considerations include:
 - All [media types](#) are considered — Obsolete or obscure media types should also include dissemination versions to ensure accessibility of materials.
 - File size and quality — Loss-less, uncompressed, archival quality files are *not* required. However, files should be as close to archival standards as possible (as outlined in these [PARADISEC guidelines](#)).

While collections are not required to meet every individual consideration, they should demonstrate a balanced alignment with the selection factors, ensuring they collectively contribute to the overarching goals and values of LDaCA.

Priorities

Collecting priorities for 2025-26 will be:

- At-risk collections and under-utilised collections
- Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander languages
- Languages other than English spoken in Australia.

Collecting priorities will be reviewed and updated annually, dependent on progress made in the growth of the collections

Delivery

Process for finding and assessing collections includes:

- Outreach/engagement campaign and research completed to identify new possible collections for inclusion based on CI, steering committee and team networks, and a public outreach campaign.
- Evaluation completed on materials identified against selection criteria and assessment of their ability to be included is complete.
- Materials assessed as low resource and meet the selection criteria to be automatically added to schedule for ingestion by the team.
- Collections that are considered high-value but might require significant work or resources to deliver will be referred to the Steering Committee for endorsement.
- For materials identified as out of scope or not suitable, a short justification (<50 words) will be prepared and shared as required.
- Steering committee is updated at every meeting of new additions to the Portal.
- An assessment is completed annually to identify language or content materials for prioritisation in the following year. An update on priorities will be reported to the Steering committee.

Out of scope

- Collections that must be purchased for inclusion

Strategic Goals & KPIs (Measurables)

The below reference to data encompasses all data ingested or to be ingested into the LDaCA central archival-repository or community portal/s.

- A. Data is findable and accessible (to those who need it).
- B. Data is secure: by secure it means that Data is stored and described according to PILARS
- C. Data is reusable and intelligible to the application of analytics methods.
- D. Data is a strong representation of Australia's linguistic diversity and equity.
- E. Data can be managed in line with appropriate Data Governance practices.

A. Data is findable and accessible (to those who need it)	B. Data is secure	C. Data is reusable and intelligible to the application of analytics methods	D. Data is a strong representation of Australia's linguistic diversity and equity	E. Data can be managed in line with appropriate Data Governance practices
A1 - Increase the availability of language data collections via the language data portals A minimum of 2% increase in content on the data portal per year	B1- At-risk collections are stabilised and able to be made available A 2% increase in at-risk content that has been stabilised per year	C1 - Collections are added that are able to be analysed with analytics tools A minimum of 2 notebooks and analytics tools are made available. per year	D1 - Collections represent the linguistic diversity of Australia A 2% increase in content in languages other than English and non spoken languages added to the data portal per year	E1 - Collections are cared for and maintained according to FAIR and CARE principles All collections adhere to FAIR and CARE principles
A2 - Language data collections are made appropriately accessible A 2% increase in content made accessible each year	B2 - Further to A2, Appropriate access controls are in place to support access to collections All collections that require access controls have the relevant controls implemented successfully	C2 Collections are available in a range of common data formats for use with analytics tools and measure could be All collections have (minimally) plain text files with appropriate and consistent character encodings (e.g. UTF8?)	D2 - Indigenous languages, knowledge, and cultural resilience are prioritised and honoured A 2% increase in Indigenous languages content added to the data portal per year	E2 - Provenance information & enriched metadata is appropriately documented All collections include provenance information and clear metadata
A3 - Users are able to find language collection data relevant for their work Contribute to an increased content use by 5%				E3 - Licensing and usage requirements are appropriately documented All collections include licensing and usage information

Implementation

Roles

- Identify and assess collections suitable for inclusion.
- Support data owners in preparing their data and making their collections available.
- Support data owners and data custodians in identifying licenses and access requirements that meet their needs.
- Support data owners and data custodians in identifying suitable storage options for their collections.
- Ingestion of materials into the data portals.
- Maintain collection details and a stable environment for viewing and accessing collection materials for the duration of the project.
- Maintain collection details collection and data quality for the duration of the project.

Responsibilities

Task	Responsible	Consulted	Informed
Identify and assess collections suitable for inclusion	Data, collections and licensing team Industry engagement and communications team	Project CIs Project advisors	Steering committee
Support data owners in preparing their data and making their collections available	Research technology team Data supplier	Research support and training team	
Support data owners and data custodians in identifying licenses and access requirements that meet their needs	Data, collections and licensing team Data supplier	Research technology team	
Support data owners and data custodians in identifying suitable storage options for their collections	Research technology team Data supplier	Data, collections and licensing team	
Ingestion of materials into data portals	Research technology team	Data, collections and licensing team	Steering committee
Maintenance of data collection infrastructure	Research technology team		
Maintenance of data and quality	LDaCA resourcing tbc Data supplier		